

Plantronics Voyager Pro and Explorer 240

For the talkatively stylish

The Voyager Pro is a large Bluetooth headset, a bane considering sleek and tiny is in. The armature that sits behind the ear is bulky but the weight belies the bulk. The mouthpiece is mounted on a long, but sleek armature. The black of the unit is relieved by a silver strip on the mouthpiece

armature and on the rear of the earpiece. The call accept/reject button is cleverly integrated into the mouthpiece armature and we missed it at first glance, but it's easy to use. The earpiece is soft silicone and pretty comfortable, for it takes the shape of your ear. Once worn the device feels comfortable, and its size doesn't



Explorer 240



Voyager Pro

Specifications

Weight: 17.6 grams.; Talk Time: 6 hours; BT version: 2.1 with EDR; dual microphones

Contact

Plantronics India Pvt. Ltd.

Phone: +91-124-4545703

Email: serviceindia@plantronics.com

Web site:

www.plantronics.com

Price: Rs 4,199 (Voyager Pro) / 2,199 (Explorer 240)

7/6
10

Voyager Pro/Explorer 240

Build Quality..... 7 / 7
Features..... 7.5 / 6.5
Performance..... 7.5 / 6
Value for Money..... 7 / 7.5

get in the way of usability. The volume buttons are intuitively placed, as is the power button. Pairing with Symbian and WM phones was a snap. The only minor problem we had was with the mouthpiece unit – the microphone has a honeycomb grille and if you haven't shaved, this keeps getting (sometimes) painfully caught in the stubble! Tapping the call button rapidly twice will dial the last called number.

In call clarity is great, voices sound clear, with no distortion but there is a slight mechanical sound to the voice – not 100 per cent natural sounding. The range is a good 15 feet or so, but a reasonably clear line of sight is a must. The moment a wall or door comes in your way, signal quality deteriorates badly. To be honest, this

happens with all headsets and is not a grouse, merely a fact. The dual microphone setup is advertised as a plus, and it is, it cuts wind noise both sides when the unit is being used outdoors, your voice is clearer, and you can hear someone speaking from a windy area. It also cuts out other to some extent, vehicle honks and machinery sounds. A boon is the support for pairing with two Bluetooth devices. Priced at Rs. 4,199, the Voyager Pro is for those wanting a comfortable, upmarket device with good performance to boot.

The Explorer 240 is a much smaller unit, with a thin plastic armature going around the ear. The earpad is rubber with a slight protrusion that is meant to stick into your ear. The device looks nice, but the barrel itself houses the electronics which is why it isn't as thin as the Voyager Pro, but then the armature of the Voyager Pro is several times bulkier. The earpiece on the Explorer 240

is not unanimously comfortable, some found it easy and rather comfortable on their ears, and some of us hated it, it hurt the outer ear and we just couldn't bear to wear it. For some, the fit wasn't snug too. Therefore, at the outset, it's one of those devices you'll need to try, whether your ears can bear it or not.

The Explorer 240 is also a decent performer, and call clarity is good. It has the same range as the Voyager Pro, although the when outdoors the Voyager Pro controls external noises better. The Explorer 240 will not isolate ambient sounds, like a car honking in the vicinity – it does reduce the sharpness and intrusion quotient of such noises, but the Voyager Pro comes closer to muting them. Priced at Rs. 2,199, it's a good deal, but we'd rather spend more and get the much better Voyager Pro.